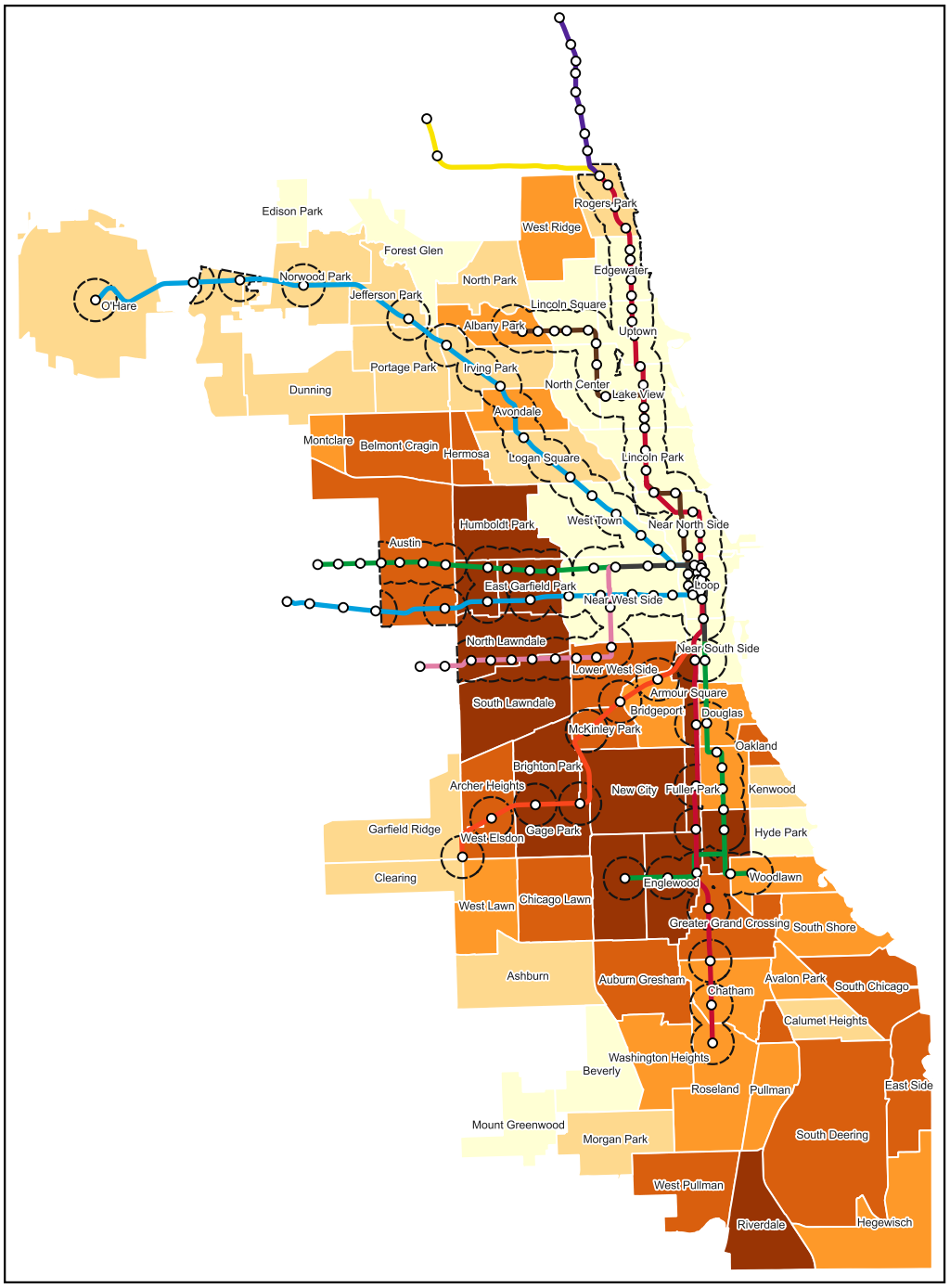
Economic Hardship and 'L' Station Access, Chicago Community Areas

Hardship index (ACS 2008-2012) with half-mile station walksheds outlined.



Legend

Hardship index (ACS 2008-2012)

- 1 - 20 (lowest hardship)
- 21 - 40
- 41 - 60
- 61 - 80
- 81 - 100 (highest hardship)
- 1/2 mile station walkshed

CTA 'L' lines

- Red
- Blue
- Brown
- Green
- Orange
- Pink
- Purple
- Yellow
- Shared track (Loop)
- 'L' stations

0 1 2 mi

Results

At the community-area level, 'L' access and hardship are not related (r = -0.03, n = 77). Areas under 10% covered average a hardship index of 47.5; areas at least half covered average 45.0. Several high-hardship areas on the West and South Sides are well served by the Green, Pink and Red lines, while the Far Southeast Side has no 'L' service.

Hardship index combines crowding, poverty, unemployment, education, dependency and income (1 = least, 100 = most).

Prepared by: Summerlyn Turner

Date: October 2025
Projection: NAD83 / Illinois East (ftUS), EPSG:3435
Data: City of Chicago Data Portal (community areas, CTA 'L' stops and lines); U.S. Census Bureau ACS 2008-2012 via the City of Chicago
Software: QGIS